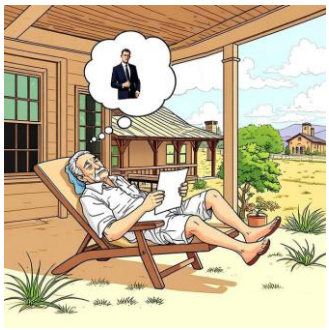
Shaken (But Not Stirred)



Felix Leiter is relaxing on the porch of his Texas ranch house when he receives a special delivery letter. He looks at the return address: “Bond, James Bond”. “No!” he cries. He tears open the envelope and finds a blank sheet of paper. This is not surprising. The letter would be in code, invisible code. Trembling, Leiter surmises the content: Bond is trying to seduce him back into action, just what he hoped he had escaped on his ranch.

To make the code visible, he has to bake the page under a heat lamp. He brings it to a tanning machine in back of his house and puts it on the bench. He slowly fingers the knob. He does not want to do this, but finally he moves the knob one tick, turning the machine on. Soon the lamp will be hot enough to reveal the code. In spite of himself, he pushes the knob one more tick. That causes the lamp to move in a slow circular path. Ordinarily this feature is intended to give the user a uniform tan over his body, but in this case it’s to move the lamp away from the page, at least until the next cycle. Leiter knows this does no more than delay the inevitable. He’s just ticking the tan round the code.